Integrated Postal Architecture
IPS Integration

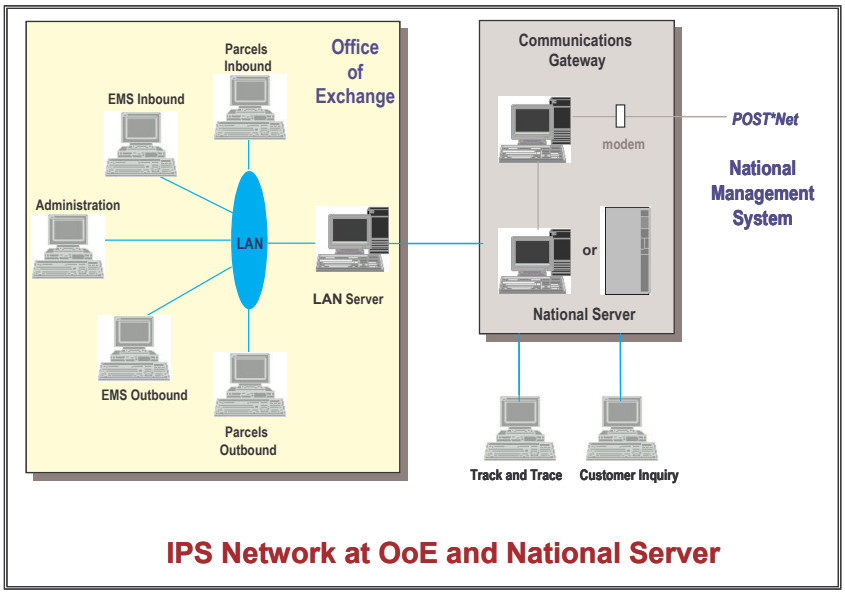
Precision Postal Software Design

The International Postal System (IPS) from the Universal Postal Union is provided to UPU member Posts for the international tracking of certain premium mail products including EMS items, Parcels and Registered Mail.

The diagram shows a local area network installed in an Office of Exchange capturing data relating to the movements of inbound and outbound mail items, receptacle, despatches and consignments.

This data is routed to and from the central IPS National Server connected to each Office of Exchange and the central IPS database is updated details relating to the mail movements.

The IPS system exchanges EDI messages via the UPU, to and from other Posts over the UPUs Post*Net global network.



IPS Network at OoE and National Server

IPS and the Integrated Postal Architecture

In the on-going competition between the Posts and the private couriers, the Posts of the world have one major disadvantage caused primarily by the lack of sophisticated communication between the Posts.

If an Express Mail item is sent from country A to country B by a private courier, then the courier will normally manage the complete international process. The courier will pick-up the items from the sending customer (or receive them at a reception centre) and deliver them directly to the receiving customer. The courier has total control of the process and can easily track the mail item from the precise moment that it is received from the sending customer, through the routing network to the delivery customer. The whole process from end-to-end is electronically monitored and the quality-of-service provided can be easily measured.

If the same item is sent through the postal network from country A to country B, then the monitoring of the movement and the management of the receiving, routing and delivery process is at the mercy of the relationship between the 2 Posts involved in the process. The tracking of the mail item from end-to-end is extremely difficult and reliable quality-of-service information is unlikely to be available.

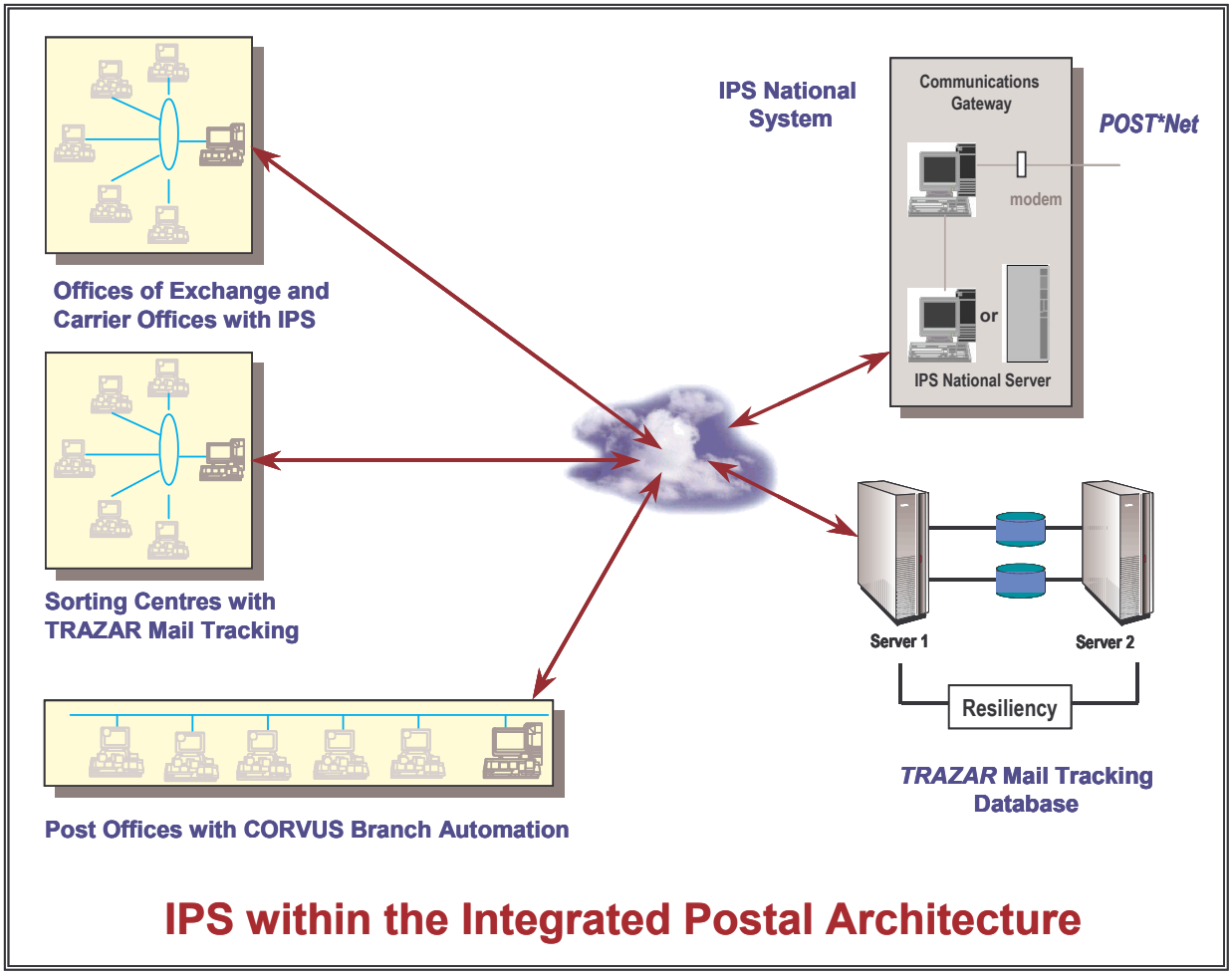
Without the quality-of-service analysis provide by capturing end-to-end movement events it is almost impossible for the Posts to improve their product offerings and compete effectively with the private couriers.

The IPS solution has solved a major part of this problem by providing the ability for Posts to exchange information relating to both inbound and outbound premium mail movement events. As stated above, what is required is the ability to capture end-to-end event information and use this to measure the quality-of-service being offered.

PSL has integrated the IPS solution within the Integrated Postal Architecture, thus providing the ability to capture the necessary movement data in order to provide the desired QoS information to management.

IPS can be integrated within the Integrated Postal Architecture in a number of ways depending upon the requirements and capabilities of the Postal Enterprise concerned. Options are:

- ⇒ Extension of IPS to the counter using *CORVUS*
- ⇒ Embedding the “Receive from Customer within a full *CORVUS* Branch/Counter automation system
- ⇒ Interfacing IPS directly to the Posts *TRAZAR* central mail tracking system
- ⇒ Interfacing to the Delivery Management module of *TRAZAR*



IPS within the Integrated Postal Architecture

Extension of IPS to the counter using *CORVUS*

A simple *CORVUS* front-end can be installed in the post offices and other receiving offices to capture the "Receive from Customer" event and pass the information through to the IPS National database.

Full *CORVUS* Branch/Counter automation system

A complete *CORVUS* implementation within the post offices will include the serving of customers for all services at the counter and the capture of relevant transaction information. Information captured relating to premium international mail items will be passed through to the IPS National database.

Interfacing IPS to the *TRAZAR* central mail tracking system

The *TRAZAR* mail tracking system will capture details and events relating to all premium mail items received by the Post, including both domestic and international items. The domestic mail items are tracked from end-to-end by *TRAZAR*. For the international outbound items, mail item information and initial events are captured on the *TRAZAR* central tracking database and routed through to the IPS database. Certain of these events will be forwarded via the Post*Net network to the delivery Post.

For inbound mail items, the information received from the sending Post will be routed via the IPS database to the *TRAZAR* tracking database. In turn this information is used by the Delivery Management module of TRAZAR in order to manage the delivery process and capture the date and time of the delivery. In turn this delivery information is routed via IPS to the originating Post such that the sending Post can ascertain the QoS provided.

Interfacing to the Delivery Management module of *TRAZAR*

If a Post is primarily interested in the measurement of the quality of the delivery of international inbound mail the delivery management module of *TRAZAR* can be implemented separately.

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